

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Crisis Reporting App
<i>Company:</i>	University of Nottingham

Contact Details

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Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☒
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Human-computer interaction; secure data storage; mobile and web application development; incident workflows; privacy-aware system design; location verification; data visualisation.

Project Background Information

Many organisations need a clearer way for staff, students, visitors or members of the public to report a concern quickly, especially when the concern is tied to a specific place, building, event or incident. Current reporting routes can be fragmented: reports may arrive by email, phone, form submissions or informal messages, making it difficult to verify what happened, where it happened, whether it is urgent, and who should respond.

This project asks a student team to propose and prototype a Crisis Reporting App: a mobile-first and/or web-based system for submitting, reviewing, validating and managing crisis-related concerns. The brief is intentionally open-ended. Teams should explore the problem space, identify a realistic user group, make sensible assumptions, and decide which features deliver the most useful and responsible minimum viable product.

Possible report types might include health and safety concerns, suspicious activity, facilities issues, welfare concerns, event disruption, environmental hazards, accessibility issues, or any other scenario the team considers appropriate. The system does not need to handle real emergencies or live operational response; it should demonstrate how software could support structured reporting, triage and follow-up in a controlled student project context.

Requirements

The group must provide:

- **A clear problem definition:** who the app is for, what kinds of concerns it supports, and what assumptions or boundaries apply.
- **A user-facing reporting flow:** for example, a mobile or responsive web interface that lets someone log a concern, add a short description, choose a category and urgency level, and optionally attach evidence such as a photo.
- **Location capture or verification:** for example, QR code scanning at known locations, manually selected locations, GPS-style mock data, room/building codes, or another approach chosen by the team.
- **A backend/API layer:** endpoints or service functions for creating, reading, updating and managing reports, with clear separation between UI and data handling.
- **Data storage design:** a database or structured storage model for reports, users/roles, locations, status history and audit information. The technology stack is deliberately agnostic.
- **An admin or moderator workflow:** a way for authorised users to review submitted concerns, validate or reject alerts, change status, add notes, and escalate or close items.
- **Privacy and responsibility considerations:** discussion of personal data, misuse, false reports, retention, role-based access, audit trails and how the prototype avoids presenting itself as a live emergency service.
- **A working prototype and short demonstration:** enough functionality to show the end-to-end journey from submitting a concern to admin review and resolution.

Students are encouraged to define additional features where appropriate. Examples include push/email notifications, public alert feeds, heatmaps or dashboards, duplicate report detection, configurable severity levels, anonymous reporting, accessibility-first mobile design, offline draft capture, role-based permissions, incident timelines, integration with a map view, or analytics on response times.

Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> • User-centred design and requirements analysis • Frontend development for mobile or responsive web interfaces • API design and client/server integration • Database modelling for reports, users, locations and status history • Basic security, authentication and role-based access concepts	<i>Desirable:</i> • QR code, geolocation or map-based interface ideas • Dashboard, filtering and data visualisation skills • Notification or messaging workflow design • Testing, validation and usability evaluation • Awareness of privacy, safeguarding, data retention and ethical constraints
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.